

Luminous

Planning Document · Recipe Discovery & Meal Planning

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Overview

Luminous is a Recipe Discovery & Meal Planning single-page React application. The name is a synonym for radiating glow and brightness — the feeling I wanted the interface to carry. It combines the visual identity of two earlier projects: the Enlighten Library (Fraunces + Inter type, the PM account badge, a terracotta accent) and Little Lemon (warm food colour), into a honey-glow palette on deep-plum ink.

Design Decisions

- **Content first:** I began with the meals and recipes, since they are what draw people to the app.
- **Cards:** I reused the card pattern from my portfolio, where I display my certificates and the projects I have built (my first project). The same idea works for laying out meals, so meals sit on cards throughout.
- **Colour:** I wanted something bright that still looked real. The choice was between green and orange, and I went with orange — a honey glow on deep-plum ink.
- **Header:** I modelled the header on the one from the Library app I built on Coursera, which carried search and favourites; I first met that layout when learning the basics of HTML and CSS. The footer follows the same source.
- **Hero section:** the first section drew inspiration from that same reference site.
- **Navigation:** the Luminous wordmark links back to the home page, and an accessibility link opens the live app to view more recipes.

Component Hierarchy

```
App (holds favourites + meal plan)
|-- Navbar --> AccountBadge
|-- Home --> Card, Loading, AudioPlayer
|-- RecipesPage --> SearchBar, RecipeFilter --> Button
|               --> RecipeList --> RecipeCard --> Card, Badge
|-- RecipeDetail --> Badge, Button, VideoPlayer
|-- MealPlannerPage --> MealPlanner --> DayCard --> MealSlot (4 levels deep)
|-- FavoritesPage --> RecipeCard --> Card, Badge
`-- Footer
```

Data Flow

- **Down (props):** App passes recipes, favorites, mealPlan and callbacks to pages; pages pass individual recipes to cards.
- **Up (callbacks):** onFavoriteToggle, onAddToPlan, onRemoveFromPlan and onClearWeek bubble user actions back to App.
- **Sibling:** Recipes, Favourites and Meal Planner all read App's state, so a change on one page is visible on the others.

State Management Strategy

- App owns the shared state: favorites, mealPlan, recipes, isLoading and notice.
- Pages own their local UI state: search term, filters, focus, and media play/pause.
- `useEffect` loads the data, hydrates from `localStorage`, and persists favourites and the weekly plan so choices survive a refresh.

Components and Their Purposes

24 components in total, all functional (0 class components).

- **App** – root container; owns shared state and routing.
- **Navbar** – top navigation, active-link styling, favourites count; brand links home.
- **AccountBadge** – the PM account badge.
- **Footer** – site footer with navigation links.
- **Button** – reusable button with variant props.
- **Card** – container wrapper using the children prop.
- **SearchBar** – search input for meals and ingredients.
- **Loading** – loading indicator during data operations.
- **Modal** – overlay container using the children prop.
- **Badge** – category and difficulty labels.
- **RecipeCard** – recipe summary card.
- **RecipeList** – renders a grid of RecipeCards.
- **RecipeDetail** – full recipe with cook-along video.
- **RecipeFilter** – category, cuisine and difficulty filters.
- **MealPlanner** – weekly planner container.
- **DayCard** – one day with breakfast, lunch and dinner slots.
- **MealSlot** – a single meal slot.
- **VideoPlayer** – HTML5 cook-along video.
- **AudioPlayer** – HTML5 cooking-tips audio.
- **Home, RecipesPage, MealPlannerPage, FavoritesPage, NotFound** – the five routed pages.

Props Documentation (Main Components)

- **RecipeCard** – recipe (object, required), isFavorite (bool), onFavoriteToggle (func), onAddToPlan (func).
- **DayCard** – day (string), meals (object), onRemove (func).
- **VideoPlayer** – videoUrl (string), title (string), poster (string).
- **Button** – variant (string), onClick (func), children (node).

Signature Feature

Favourites are split into meal-type compartments, and adding a favourite to a day routes it to the matching planner slot (breakfast to breakfast) — but only when that slot is still open.